32_OFFLINE_MODE.md

Offline Experience Specification

Version 1.0

Priority: HIGH

Status: MVP

Purpose

UNPLND should remain useful even without an internet connection.

Users often lose connection while traveling, hiking, driving or exploring new places.

The app must fail gracefully.

Never leave the user stranded.

Philosophy

Offline is not an error.

Offline is a supported experience.

The user should always know what is still available.

Offline Strategy

Online First

AI Planning

Discover

Search

Weather

Nearby Places

Partner Content

Offline First

Albums

Favorites

Current Route

Completed Routes

Settings

Profile

Memory Timeline

Cache Strategy

Automatically cache

Current active route

Last 20 albums

Favorites

Recent plans

App settings

Profile information

Recently viewed collections

Never cache sensitive authentication secrets outside secure storage.

Active Evening

If connection is lost during an active evening:

Continue navigation.

Continue timeline.

Continue stop completion.

Store progress locally.

Sync automatically when online.

The evening should never be interrupted.

Planner

Requires internet.

If offline:

Show explanation.

Offer:

Saved routes

Favorites

Previous evenings

Do not show generic error messages.

Albums

Albums remain fully accessible offline.

Includes

Metadata

Timeline

Downloaded images

Map preview (if cached)

Notes

Users should always be able to relive memories.

Favorites

Always available offline.

Includes

Saved places

Saved collections

Saved routes

Sync changes later.

Offline Queue

Queue actions locally.

Examples

Favorite added

Album edited

Stop completed

Profile updated

Automatically synchronize when connection returns.

Conflict Resolution

MVP

Last Write Wins

Future

Smart merge strategy

Prompt only when necessary.

Avoid user confusion.

Sync Engine

Detect reconnection.

Process queued actions.

Retry failed requests.

Resolve conflicts.

Update UI silently.

Never interrupt the user.

Connectivity States

Online

Limited Connection

Offline

Syncing

Display only subtle indicators.

Never use alarming warnings.

Offline Banner

Small banner.

Example

You're offline.

Your memories are still available.

Hidden automatically when connection returns.

Downloaded Content

Future feature

Users may download:

Albums

Adventure Packs

Curated city guides

Road trip collections

Map Behavior

If map tiles are cached:

Display normally.

Otherwise:

Fallback to simplified route view.

Never display a broken map.

Photos

Downloaded photos available offline.

Pending uploads remain in upload queue.

Retry automatically.

Notifications

Local reminders continue working offline.

Push notifications require internet.

Error Handling

Instead of

Network Error

Show

You're offline.

We'll continue once you're connected.

Human language only.

Performance

Offline content should load instantly.

Target

<200ms

Navigation remains smooth.

Animations remain available.

Analytics

Track

offline_mode_entered

offline_sync_started

offline_sync_completed

offline_conflict

cache_hit

cache_miss

Use aggregated metrics only.

Accessibility

Offline indicators readable.

VoiceOver supported.

No flashing alerts.

High contrast.

Delight Checklist

✓ Offline feels intentional.

✓ Memories always available.

✓ Active evenings continue.

✓ Sync happens automatically.

✓ User never feels punished.

DO NOT

Do NOT block access to albums.

Do NOT lose user actions.

Do NOT require manual sync.

Do NOT show technical network errors.

Do NOT interrupt an evening because of poor connectivity.

Success Criteria

A user loses internet halfway through an evening.

They continue using UNPLND naturally.

When the connection returns,

everything synchronizes automatically.

The user barely notices.

Golden Rule

Connectivity should never decide whether memories are created.

UNPLND should remain dependable,

wherever the evening goes.

Claude Instructions

Design every feature with offline behavior in mind.

For each new feature ask:

What happens if the user loses connection right now?

If the answer is unclear,

the feature is incomplete.

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